



Saint Columban College
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Runme.py

runme.py 



Easy

General Skills

Beginner picoMini 2022

Python

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Description

Run the `runme.py` script to get the flag. Download the script with your browser or with `wget` in the webshell.

[Download runme.py Python script](#)

Hints 

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 picoCTF{FLAG}

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Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Runme.py

Category: General Skills

Date: 01/15/26



I. Objective

To run a provided Python script in order to retrieve the flag.

II. Background

In many beginner CTF challenges, the goal is simply to understand how programs are executed rather than reverse engineering them. This challenge introduces participants to running Python scripts, recognizing file names, and using basic command-line tools. It emphasizes that sometimes the simplest solution—running the program as intended—is all that is required.

III. Tool Used

- **Oracle VirtualBox (Kali Linux)** – Used as the Linux environment
- **Linux Terminal** – Used to execute decoding commands
- **PicoCTF webshell** – **Alternative environment provided by picoCTF**
- **Programiz – Online Python interpreter (optional)**
- **wget** – Used to download the Python file
- **Python 3 Interpreter** – Used to execute the script

IV. Methodology

1. Opened Kali Linux in VirtualBox (forgot to mention that any Linux terminal works in other files).
Alternatively, the picoCTF WebShell can be used.
2. Downloaded the provided Python file is optional. In my case, I copied the link address then use it to pair with wget.
3. Ran the script using the command:
`python3 runme.py`
4. The script executed successfully and printed the flag directly to the terminal.



V. Result

picoCTF{run_s4n1ty_run}

```
kali@kali:~$  
$ wget https://artifacts.picoctf.net/c/34/runme.py  
--2026-01-15 08:09:40-- https://artifacts.picoctf.net/c/34/runme.py  
Resolving artifacts.picoctf.net (artifacts.picoctf.net)... 10.172.21.63, 10.172.21.26, 10.172.21.12, ...  
Connecting to artifacts.picoctf.net (artifacts.picoctf.net)|10.172.21.43|:443... connected.  
HTTP request sent, awaiting response... 200 OK  
Length: 270 [application/octet-stream]  
Saving to: 'runme.py'  
  
runme.py 100%[=====] 270 --.-KB/s 10 0s  
2026-01-15 08:09:41 (270 MB/s) - 'runme.py' saved [270/270]  
  
kali@kali:~$  
$ python3 runme.py  
picoCTF{run_s4n1ty_run}  
  
kali@kali:~$
```

(Oracle Virtual Box – Kali Linux)

```
wwg@_g-picoctf@webshell:~$ wget https://artifacts.picoctf.net/c/34/runme.py  
--2026-01-15 08:55:26-- https://artifacts.picoctf.net/c/34/runme.py  
Resolving artifacts.picoctf.net (artifacts.picoctf.net)... 3.160.22.128, 3.160.22.16,  
3.160.22.92, ...  
Connecting to artifacts.picoctf.net (artifacts.picoctf.net)|3.160.22.128|:443... conne  
cted.  
HTTP request sent, awaiting response... 200 OK  
Length: 270 [application/octet-stream]  
Saving to: 'runme.py'  
  
runme.py 100%[=====>] 270 --.-KB/s in 0s  
2026-01-15 08:55:27 (30.8 MB/s) - 'runme.py' saved [270/270]  
  
s@_g-picoctf@webshell:~$ pyhton3 runme.py  
-bash: pyhton3: command not found  
s@_g-picoctf@webshell:~$ python3 runme.py  
picoCTF{run_s4n1ty_run}  
s@_g-picoctf@webshell:~$ timed out waiting for input: auto-logout
```

(PicoCTF Webshell)

VI. Explanation

This challenge does not require debugging or reverse engineering. The Python file already contains the flag stored in a variable and prints it when executed.



An alternative method is to simply open the file and read the source code, since the flag is visible in plain text. However, running the script using a Linux terminal or picoCTF WebShell demonstrates proper usage of Python execution and basic command-line skills.

Using **wget** introduces an efficient way to retrieve files directly from the terminal, which is useful in real-world environments where graphical downloads may not be available.

VII. Conclusion

The **Runme.py** challenge reinforces the importance of understanding how to execute programs in their intended environment. It highlights that not all CTF problems are complex—some are designed to test familiarity with tools, commands, and workflows. Mastery of these basics is essential for progressing to more advanced cybersecurity challenges.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**